

Word family: **sentimental / sentimentally / sentimentality / sentiment / sentimentalism / sentimentalist**

Base word: sentimental

Related forms: sentiment, sentiments, sentimentally, sentimentality, sentimentalism, sentimentalist

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / related nouns and adverb (相關名詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “It looks good, it is practical, and it has **sentimental value**, so it ticks all the boxes for me.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **sentimental** means **valuable or important because of the personal memories, feelings, or emotional associations connected with something, rather than because of its practical or financial worth**.

繁體中文： **有感情價值的；因為與個人回憶、感情或重要經歷有連結而顯得珍貴的**

中文翻譯：

> “...it has **sentimental value**...”

「.....它還具有**紀念價值 / 情感價值**.....」

Here:

sentimental value = 因個人回憶、關係或經歷而產生的情感價值，不一定等同金錢價值

1. **sentimental = connected with tender personal feelings/memories (感情) — 感性的；充滿感情的**

Meaning: Strongly connected with affectionate, tender, nostalgic, or personal feelings.

Practice 1

> “She became **sentimental** when she looked through her childhood photographs.”

「她翻看童年照片時變得很**感性 / 充滿感觸**。」

Practice 2

> “The song has a **sentimental** meaning for me.”

「這首歌對我有很深的**情感意義**。」

sentimental = 容易因回憶、關係、舊事或感情而產生溫柔、懷念或感觸的

Common:

- * sentimental memories
- * sentimental feelings
- * sentimental attachment
- * sentimental reasons
- * sentimental meaning

2. **sentimental value = emotional/personal value (紀念價值) — 情感價值；紀念價值**

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The jacket has a lot of **sentimental value** for me.”

「這件外套對我很高的**紀念價值 / 情感價值**。」

Practice 4

> “The watch is not expensive, but it has great **sentimental value**.”

「這隻手錶並不昂貴，但有很大的**紀念價值**。」

Practice 5

> “I kept the letter for its **sentimental value**.”

「我因為它的**情感價值**而保留了那封信。」

sentimental value = 某件物品因與回憶、家人、朋友、重要人生經歷等有連結而具有的非金錢價值

This belongs to Meaning 1, but it is important enough to store as a major fixed collocation.

3. **sentimental = overly emotional in a way that seems unrealistic or excessive (負面) — 多愁善感的；過度煽情的**

****Sentimental**** can also be critical.

It may describe a person, film, book, speech, etc. that expresses emotion too strongly, especially in a way that seems exaggerated, artificial, or lacking realism.

Practice 6

> “The film becomes too ****sentimental**** near the end.”

「這部電影到了結尾變得有點太****煽情 / 多愁善感****。」

Practice 7

> “His speech was sincere without becoming ****sentimental****.”

「他的演講很真誠，但沒有變得過分****煽情****。」

****sentimental** = 感情表達過多、過甜或過度理想化，以致令人覺得不自然或煽情******

This is a genuinely distinct evaluative branch.

4. ****sentimental** = guided more by feelings than practical reasoning (決定 / 看法) — 感情用事的；基於感情的******

****Sentimental**** can describe decisions, attitudes, or reasons based more on emotional attachment than on practical or rational considerations.

Practice 8

> “I kept the old chair for ****sentimental**** reasons.”

「我因為****感情上的原因****保留了那張舊椅子。」

Practice 9

> “His decision was partly ****sentimental****.”

「他的決定部分是出於****感情因素****。」

****sentimental** = 主要受個人感情、回憶或依戀影響，而不是純粹按照實際利益或理性作判斷的******

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but the emphasis is on ****motivation for a decision****.

For strict counting, I would merge it with #1.

5. **sentimental = nostalgic / attached to the past (懷舊) — 懷舊的 ; 念舊的**

Sentimental can emphasize affection for the past, old places, objects, relationships, or memories.

Practice 10

> “He is very **sentimental** about his old school.”

「他對母校非常**懷念 / 有感情**。」

Practice 11

> “I’m too **sentimental** to throw these letters away.”

「我太**念舊 / 太有感情**了，捨不得把這些信丟掉。」

be sentimental about something = 因為回憶和情感依戀而對某人 / 某物特別有感觸

For core counting, this belongs to Meaning 1.

6. **sentimental = romanticized or emotionally idealized (理想化) — 浪漫化的 ; 感情化的**

Sometimes **sentimental** suggests viewing something through emotionally idealized memories rather than realistically.

Practice 12

> “He has a rather **sentimental** view of village life.”

「他對鄉村生活抱有相當**浪漫化 / 感情化**的看法。」

Practice 13

> “The book avoids a **sentimental** picture of childhood.”

「這本書避免把童年描寫得過於**浪漫化 / 煽情**。」

This often overlaps with the negative “overly emotional” branch.

7. **sentimental = relating to a literary/artistic tradition emphasizing emotion (文學史) — 感傷主義的；感傷文學的**

In literary history, **sentimental** can describe works or traditions that deliberately emphasize feeling, sympathy, sensibility, and emotional response.

Examples include:

- * sentimental novel
- * sentimental literature
- * sentimental drama

Practice 14

> “The course examines the rise of the **sentimental** novel.”

「這門課探討**感傷小說**的興起。」

This is an established historical/literary sense, but it is specialist and lower priority for general learners.

Related form: **sentiment**

Sentiment is an important related noun and has its own polysemy.

For this family entry, the most relevant branches are:

**sentiment = feeling/emotional attitude (感情 / 情緒) **

> “The speech expressed strong patriotic sentiment.”

「這篇演講表達了強烈的感情 / 情緒立場。」

**sentiment = opinion or attitude held by people (看法 / 態度) **

> “Public sentiment changed.”

「公眾態度改變了。」

Because **sentiment** has developed meanings beyond simply “feeling,” it deserves its own full entry if targeted later rather than being treated as mechanically identical to **sentimental**.

Related form: ****sentimentally****

****Sentimentally**** means in an emotional, nostalgic, or excessively emotional way.

Practice 15

> “She smiled ****sentimentally**** at the old photograph.”

「她帶着****懷念和感觸****看着那張舊照片微笑。」

Practice 16

> “The story treats the subject rather ****sentimentally****.”

「這個故事對該主題的處理方式相當****煽情****。」

Context decides whether it is neutral/warm or negative.

Related form: ****sentimentality****

****Sentimentality**** means excessive or conspicuous emotionality, especially when judged negatively.

Practice 17

> “The novel sometimes slips into ****sentimentality****.”

「這本小說有時會變得過分****煽情 / 感傷****。」

****sentimentality = 過度強調感情、容易流於煽情或多愁善感的特質****

This noun is more often negative than neutral.

Related form: ****sentimentalism****

****Sentimentalism**** can mean:

1. excessive reliance on or display of emotion;
2. historically, a literary/philosophical tendency emphasizing feeling and moral sentiment.

Practice 18

> “The critic accused the film of **sentimentalism**.”

「評論者批評這部電影過於**感傷 / 煽情**。」

This is more formal and specialist than **sentimentality**.

Related form: **sentimentalist**

A **sentimentalist** is someone who is strongly guided by sentimental feelings, or who tends toward sentimentalism.

Practice 19

> “He is a **sentimentalist** who keeps every old letter.”

「他是個非常**念舊、多愁善感**的人，每封舊信都保留下來。」

This is valid but lower-frequency.

Important distinction: **sentimental vs emotional**

emotional

is very broad:

> strongly affected by emotion.

sentimental

more specifically suggests:

- * tender feelings
- * nostalgia
- * personal attachment
- * memories
- * sometimes excessive emotionality

> emotional reaction

> sentimental attachment

A person can be emotional because of anger or fear without being sentimental.

Important distinction: ****sentimental vs nostalgic****

****nostalgic****

specifically means feeling affection or longing for the past.

****sentimental****

is broader and can involve:

- * memories
- * relationships
- * personal objects
- * tenderness
- * excessive emotion

> nostalgic about childhood

> sentimental about an old gift

There is substantial overlap.

Important distinction: ****sentimental vs affectionate****

****affectionate****

means showing warmth, fondness, or love toward someone.

****sentimental****

often involves emotional associations, memory, or nostalgia.

> affectionate hug

> sentimental memory

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: ****sentimental vs romantic****

romantic

can refer to love/romance or idealized imagination.

sentimental

focuses more on tender emotional attachment or excessive feeling.

> romantic relationship

> sentimental attachment to an old object

Important distinction: **sentimental vs sensitive**

sensitive

means easily affected by feelings or aware of others' feelings.

sentimental

means especially prone to tender, nostalgic, emotionally attached feelings.

Someone can be sensitive without being sentimental.

Important distinction: **sentimental vs maudlin**

maudlin

means excessively and self-indulgently sentimental, often in an embarrassing way.

sentimental

can be completely neutral or positive.

So:

> sentimental memory

can be warm and positive.

> maudlin speech

is strongly negative.

Important distinction: **sentimental vs sappy**

sappy

is informal and usually negative, meaning excessively sweet or sentimental.

> sappy romantic film

Sentimental is much broader and can be neutral.

Important distinction: **sentimental value vs monetary value**

This is particularly important for your passage.

monetary value

= what something is worth financially

sentimental value

= what something means emotionally to its owner

An object can have:

> very little monetary value

> enormous sentimental value

That is exactly the contrast implied by your denim jacket.

Grammar note: **sentimental about**

A very common construction:

> **be sentimental about + person/place/object/past experience**

Examples:

> sentimental about childhood

> sentimental about an old house

> sentimental about family photographs

Grammar note: **sentimental reasons/value/attachment**

Highly useful collocations:

- * sentimental value
- * sentimental reasons
- * sentimental attachment
- * sentimental memories
- * sentimental journey
- * sentimental favourite

The Chinese translation may vary considerably, but the English concept often stays within the **emotional attachment / nostalgia** branch.

Countability note

Sentimental is an adjective.

Sentimentality and **sentimentalism** are usually uncountable abstract nouns.

Sentiment can be countable or uncountable depending on meaning:

- > a common sentiment
- > public sentiment

That belongs in the separate **sentiment** entry.

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

- * **sentimental**
- * **sentimentally**
- * **sentimentality**
- * **sentiment**
- * **sentiments**
- * **sentimentalism**
- * **sentimentalist**

The core semantic tension is important:

****sentimental**** can be warmly positive/neutral:

- > sentimental value
- > sentimental memories

or disapproving:

- > overly sentimental film
- > sentimental nonsense

The word therefore should not automatically be translated as either only 「感性的」 or only 「煽情的」. Context determines whether the emotionality is valued or criticized.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sentimental — emotional attachment	因個人回憶、關係或經歷而產生溫柔、懷念或依戀感情的
sentimental value	因回憶、關係或經歷而產生的非金錢情感 / 紀念價值
sentimental — excessive emotion	感情表達過度、過甜或理想化，以致顯得煽情 / 多愁善感的
sentimental reasons	基於情感、回憶或依戀而非純粹實際考慮的原因
sentimental about the past	對過去、舊物或往事特別念舊、有感情的
sentimental — literary	與感傷主義 / 強調情感與感受的文學傳統有關；專門
sentimentally	感性地、懷念地；亦可指煽情地
sentimentality	過度感傷 / 煽情的特質
sentimentalism	感傷主義；或過度依賴感情的傾向
sentimentalist	很念舊、多愁善感或偏重感情的人

For your original sentence

> “It looks good, it is practical, and it has ****sentimental value****...”

The exact meaning is:

****sentimental = 因這件外套與首爾旅行、朋友和一段快樂回憶連結在一起，所以它具有超越實際用途和金錢價格的情感價值****

So:

> ****sentimental value****

= **紀念價值 / 情感價值**

The jacket may become faded or worn, but that does not reduce this kind of value—in fact, accumulating memories may make its sentimental value even greater.

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **sentimental**:

1. **connected with tender personal feelings, memories, nostalgia, or emotional attachment**
2. **excessively emotional or idealized in a way that may seem unrealistic or overly sweet**

I would keep **sentimental value / sentimental reasons / sentimental attachment** under #1, treat historical-literary **sentimental** as a lower-priority domain extension, and keep **sentiment / sentimentality / sentimentalism / sentimentalist** as related family members rather than inflating the adjective count.